

Phishing Attac



Phishing Awareness Training

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship · Presented by
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The Threat Is Real – and Growing

Cybersecurity threats are escalating rapidly across the digital landscape. Among the most prevalent and damaging is **phishing** – a deceptive technique used to steal sensitive user data.

Awareness is your first and most powerful line of defense.



Passwords



Bank Details

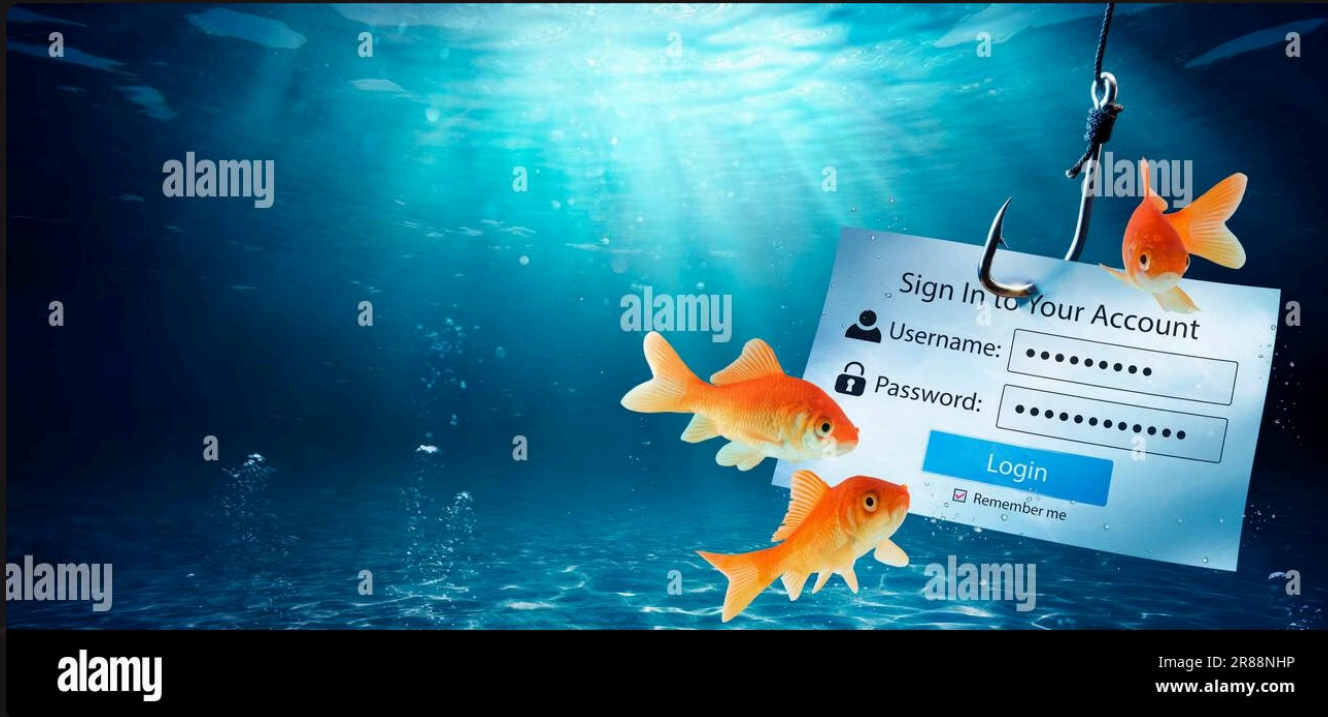


OTPs



Personal Info

What Is Phishing?



Phishing is a cyber attack where criminals **impersonate trusted organizations** to trick users into revealing confidential information — through fake emails, SMS messages, websites, or phone calls.

Common impersonation targets include:

- Banks and financial institutions
- Social media platforms
- Online shopping websites
- Government agencies

Types of Phishing Attacks



Email Phishing

Fraudulent emails that request sensitive information or direct users to fake websites.



Smishing

Phishing attacks delivered through SMS text messages, often with malicious links.



Vishing

Voice call scams where attackers pose as official support representatives.



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attacks on a specific individual using personalized information.



Clone Phishing

Duplicate of a legitimate email, altered with a malicious link or attachment.

How a Phishing Attack Unfolds



Each step is designed to appear legitimate — making awareness of the pattern critical to stopping the attack before Step 3.

Anatomy of a Phishing Email

⊗ **URGENT! Your Bank Account Will Be Blocked**

"Dear Customer, your account has been compromised. Click the link below *immediately* to verify your account or it will be permanently suspended."

→ <http://secure-banklogin.xyz/verify>

⚠ Warning Signs

- **Urgency language** – pressures fast, unthinking action
- **Unknown or spoofed sender** address
- **Suspicious URL** – misspelled domain names
- **Poor grammar** and spelling errors
- **Requests for credentials** or personal data

This example contains multiple classic red flags that should immediately raise suspicion.



Social Engineering: The Human Exploit

Beyond technical trickery, phishing relies on **psychological manipulation** – exploiting human emotion to bypass rational thinking.

😬 Fear

Fake account suspension threats

😄 Excitement

Fake lottery or prize winnings

🕒 Urgency

OTP scams and "act now" demands

🔍 Curiosity

Fake job offers and package alerts

How to Identify a Phishing Attack



Key Red Flags to Watch For

- **Suspicious sender address** — slightly misspelled or unrecognized domain
- **Unknown attachments** — unexpected files, especially .exe or .zip
- **Urgent or threatening language** — designed to pressure quick action
- **Requests for passwords or OTPs** — no legitimate org will ask for these
- **Unusual or shortened links** — hover to preview before clicking

Prevention: Your Cybersecurity Checklist

1

Don't Click Suspicious Links

Hover over links to verify the URL before clicking.
When in doubt, navigate directly.

2

Enable Two-Factor Authentication

2FA adds a critical second layer — even stolen passwords won't grant access.

3

Verify Sender Identity

Cross-check email addresses and call back on official numbers if unsure.

4

Use Antivirus & Update Software

Keep systems patched and use reputable antivirus to catch malicious content.

 Never share an OTP with anyone — no bank, government agency, or tech support will ever ask for it.

Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

Phishing is one of the most dangerous and prevalent cyber threats today — and it exploits **you**, not just your devices. Awareness, caution, and consistent best practices are the strongest shields available.

Key Takeaway

Think before you click. Verify before you share.

Your Role

Every employee is a line of defense against phishing attacks.

Next Step

Report suspicious emails to your IT/security team immediately.

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